

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Khalid Langhi

Address: Flat 68 Sutton Park House 15 Carshalton Road Sutton SM1 4GN

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am writing in strong support of Planning Application DM2025/01591.

I am a lifelong local resident who grew up in Belmont, specifically on Balmoral Way (SM2 6PD), where the former ambulance station was quite literally visible from my bedroom window. Although I have recently moved nearby, I remain closely connected to the area, with my parents and siblings still living adjacent to the site. I continue to attend and walk to community events in Belmont, including weekly congregations at St John's Community Hall. I am now 26 years old and have lived in this area my entire life, attending The Avenue Primary School and Overton Grange School for my secondary and sixth form studies.

Having grown up here as a young person, I strongly feel that a community hub of this nature would have been a valuable asset to many of us. The proposal to change the use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to a mixed-use facility under Classes F1 (Place of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) presents a meaningful opportunity to further strengthen what is already a supportive and close-knit community.

The proposed development offers clear community benefits, including health and wellbeing programmes, educational activities for children, and inclusive facilities that serve the wider community regardless of religion. The dedicated space and activities for women are particularly important to me personally, as I want my mother, sister and wife to feel comfortable, welcomed and supported within their own local community. Providing a safe and inclusive environment for women to gather, learn and access support is a significant benefit of this proposal. The educational programmes for young people will offer constructive outlets, mentorship and guidance,

which are essential for youth development and community cohesion.

In terms of scale and design, the building remains modest and in keeping with the character of the surrounding area. The part one, part two-storey extension and height increase appear proportionate and appropriate for the site. Importantly, this proposal represents a relatively low-intensity use compared to other potential forms of redevelopment that could occur on this site.

Concerns around traffic and congestion have clearly been considered. The provision of 12 on-site parking spaces, including 2 disabled bays, demonstrates thoughtful planning. In addition, cycle racks and sustainable travel provisions encourage environmentally responsible access. The staggering of Friday prayer times to avoid conflict with nearby school pick-up hours is a responsible and proactive measure that reflects genuine engagement with the local context. I do not believe the proposal will result in significant traffic, noise or light disturbance beyond what would reasonably be expected for a community facility.

It is also worth noting that the site previously operated as a working ambulance station. Growing up, I regularly witnessed flashing lights and heard sirens at all hours of the day and night. In comparison, this proposed community use would be far less disruptive than the historic emergency service operations that once took place there.

I also welcome the retention of greenery on the site, ensuring that the development integrates respectfully into its surroundings rather than appearing overdeveloped.

Having witnessed Belmont grow from a quieter residential area into a thriving and supportive neighbourhood, I believe this proposal would be a positive uplift for the area. It will provide structure, guidance and opportunity for young people, create inclusive community space, and strengthen social ties across generations.

For these reasons, I respectfully ask the Council to approve Planning Application DM2025/01591.